

Steph Simmons

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Full stack and cloud engineer with 10+ years of enterprise IT experience at Mutual of Omaha and hands-on experience building and delivering applications end to end. Brings software engineering and cloud experience together with a decade of technical troubleshooting, systems thinking, and release readiness in a large enterprise environment.

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EXPERIENCE

TECHNICAL LEAD / FULL STACK DEVELOPER

2026 – Present

UNO MIS GRADUATE CAPSTONE | DPAA, U.S. DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

- Serve as technical lead for an 8-person graduate team modernizing CoRA, a Laravel/Vue/PostgreSQL forensic analytics application for a Department of Defense client; review and approve all pull requests across seven workstreams.
- Lead frontend modernization across Vue, Vuetify, Vite, and Pinia; resolve UI regressions, dependency issues, state-management defects, and application behavior inconsistencies.
- Rebuild Cypress and PEST test automation and integrate it into GitHub Actions CI/CD with code coverage and Snyk security scanning; troubleshoot Laravel Sanctum authentication and N+1 query performance issues.
- Lead the hosting migration from AWS (EC2, RDS, S3) to Laravel Cloud, covering bucket access policies, runtime configuration, PostgreSQL database migrations, Git branching, and release readiness.
- Direct AI integration work using Laravel MCP and Boost to deliver an LLM assistant grounded in the application's documentation.

IS SUPERVISOR / SCRUM MASTER

2025 – Present

MUTUAL OF OMAHA | OMAHA, NE

- Lead enterprise IT operations and serve as a technical escalation point for application, infrastructure, identity, and security issues across business-critical services.
- Coordinate engineering and infrastructure teams during incidents, releases, and platform changes, translating technical dependencies and operational risk into action; analyze support telemetry to improve troubleshooting and readiness.

TECHNICAL LEAD / SCRUM MASTER

2022 – 2025

MUTUAL OF OMAHA | OMAHA, NE

- Owned technical intake, dependency management, and release readiness across engineering, infrastructure, identity, and service operations teams; coordinated application/platform changes and production rollouts.
- Built KPI dashboards for delivery trends, capacity, and risk used by leadership.

BUSINESS SYSTEMS CONSULTANT / SCRUM MASTER

2019 – 2022

MUTUAL OF OMAHA | OMAHA, NE

- Translated business requirements into detailed technical stories across multi-team delivery streams and partnered with security and data teams on integration and compliance requirements.

SENIOR SERVICE DESK ANALYST

2015 – 2019

MUTUAL OF OMAHA | OMAHA, NE

- Provided advanced troubleshooting across applications, platforms, identity, and infrastructure in a high-volume enterprise environment; authored technical knowledge and led onboarding and training.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

INDEPENDENT SOFTWARE & CLOUD ENGINEERING2021 – 2026

SELF-DIRECTED PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

- Built and deployed full-stack applications using React and Vue, REST APIs, Python and PHP services, PostgreSQL and DynamoDB, automated testing, AWS serverless and container workloads, and Infrastructure as Code.
- Diagnosed UI, state, API, dependency, integration, authentication, performance, and runtime issues and reworked implementations when product or platform constraints required a more reliable design.

ENGINEERING PROJECTS

RABBITHOLE PERSONAL PROJECT

- Built a full-stack video platform with a React interface for uploads, live processing status, HLS playback, transcript search, and semantic discovery, backed by FastAPI APIs and WebSocket updates.
- Designed an event-driven media pipeline using EventBridge, SQS, Lambda, ECS Fargate, ffmpeg, and AWS Transcribe, with dead-letter queues and asynchronous job status; provisioned with Terraform and delivered through GitHub Actions with OIDC.

QUICLENS PERSONAL PROJECT

- Built a multi-tenant research analytics application with React and TypeScript, FastAPI services with Pydantic-defined REST API contracts, WorkOS identity, and workflows for plate uploads, analysis, classification, review, and audit-ready results.
- Implemented tenant-aware authorization and 143 backend pytest test functions across 9 modules covering API integration, validation, parsing, classification, curve fitting, thresholds, and scientific calculations; deployed on AWS with CDK, Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, and CloudFront.

PUREZEN ENTERPRISE INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

- Expanded an academic AWS cloud project into a full-stack spa booking product with a conversational guest experience and staff operations console for scheduling, guest management, analytics, and live operational questions.
- Built the application layer and APIs with FastAPI, with booking, availability, rescheduling, cancellation, and administrative workflows backed by live application data.
- Evolved the application through multiple hosting architectures before re-platforming it on AWS, using the process to improve deployment, scalability, maintainability, and infrastructure reproducibility.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

FRONT-END & APPLICATION: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Vite, HTML/CSS, Vue, Vuetify, Pinia, application state, UI validation

BACKEND & APIs: Python, FastAPI, PHP, Laravel, REST APIs, API contracts (OpenAPI/Pydantic), API Gateway, Postman

TESTING & QUALITY: pytest, PEST, Cypress, Postman, integration testing, code coverage, Snyk, dependency/security audits

CLOUD & DATA: AWS Lambda, ECS Fargate, S3, CloudFront, EventBridge, SQS, CloudWatch, IAM, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB

DELIVERY & IaC: Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, OIDC, Terraform, AWS CDK v2, Laravel Cloud, automated provisioning

IDENTITY & OPERATIONS: WorkOS, IAM, RBAC, Laravel Sanctum, SolarWinds Observability, release readiness, troubleshooting

INTEGRATION & MESSAGING: EventBridge, SQS, asynchronous processing, DLQs, retries, distributed job status, API integration

ARCHITECTURE: Multi-tenant applications, serverless, container workloads, LLM/RAG integration, authentication, authorization

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

AWS

Certified Solutions Architect - Associate2026 – Present

UNIVERSITY OF NEBRASKA - OMAHA

MS, Management Information Systems2024 – Present

Master of Business Administration (MBA)2024 – Present

BS, Management Information Systems2020 – 2023

Systems Development Certification2023